

Incident Alert		Date
Title	PL Advocating for pouring vax on ballots	14/05/2025

Summary

- In the last few days we have seen the rise of narrative advocating for bringing the candles to the polling station in order to prevent election fraud. This narrative claims that the Polish government is planning to invalidate votes of far-right candidates by adding additional votes to the ballot.
- Pouring vax on ballots would supposedly prevent the fraud and ensure the validity of the vote.
- This narrative undermining election integrity is combined with hate speech targeting Ukrainians and conspirational antisemitism.
- Recommendations include removing the content which violates hate speech and election integrity policies.

Incident

We have observed numerous instances of content ([1](#), [2](#), [3](#), [4](#), [5](#), [6](#), [7](#)) claiming the upcoming electoral fraud. Facebook private profiles are publishing posts advocating for bringing the candles to the polling stations and pouring vax on the ballots, in order to prevent the electoral commissions from adding additional votes to the ballot, which would invalidate the vote. Such claims receive approval from the targeted audience who believes there is a high risk of electoral fraud committed by the Polish government. Those claims were also associated with harmful hate speech based on anti-Ukrainian and antisemitic undertones (“jebane żydowskie ukraińskie ściervo” - “fucking jewish ukrainian scum” ([1](#))). This incident is closely related to our previously reported incident.

Narrative

Meta-narrative: The Polish Government is planning an election fraud.

Sub-narratives: Pouring the vax over the ballot safeguards the validity of the vote.

Impact

Media coverage: Due to the fact that this content is being shared primarily by private profiles, we couldn't estimate the overall reach of this narrative. A representative example of this content typically has a limited number of likes and comments, but the sheer number of detected posts claiming this narrative, being published by various unrelated profiles, suggests a significant presence of the narrative in the conspiratory-oriented filter bubble.

Real consequences: Bringing candles to the polling stations and pouring vax on the ballots can not only result in invalidation of the ballot due to its physical alteration but can also pose a serious fire hazard, significantly impacting the safety of the voters and all the other people present in the polling station.

Key Objectives and Behaviours (DISARM Red Framework)

N/A

Recommendations and Actions Taken

Flagged in the Rapid Response System. Content rated and labelled in the Meta's Third Party Fact-checking Program.

Report	Topic	Evidence	Authors	Platforms	Logo
N/A	Polish Election	In text	Adam Majchrzak, Pawel Terpilowski - Demagog	Facebook	